

Sistine Chapel

Vatican chapel embellished by some of the greatest masterpieces of Renaissance art

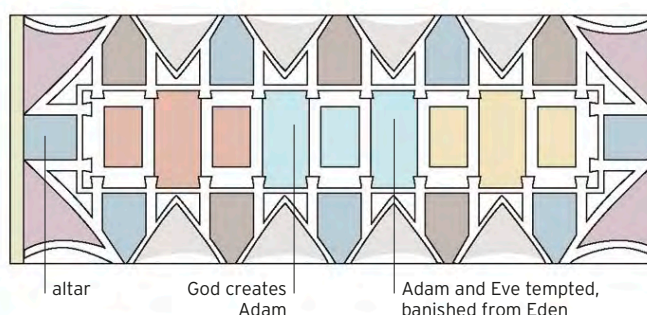


Forming part of the Papal palace at the Vatican in Rome, the Sistine Chapel was built on the orders of Pope Sixtus IV in 1475. It is the room in which the conclave of cardinals meets to elect a new Pope, but its fame rests even more upon the quality of the art it contains. Sixtus commissioned some of the leading painters of his time, including Pietro Perugino, Sandro Botticelli, and Domenico Ghirlandaio, to cover the chapel walls with frescoes. In 1508, Sixtus's nephew Pope Julius II tasked the Florentine artist Michelangelo Buonarroti with painting the chapel ceiling. It took Michelangelo 4 years to complete this astonishing work, which covers an area of more than 5,400 square ft (500 square m). Between 1536 and 1541, as a much older man, he returned to paint the wall fresco of the Last Judgment, often considered his masterpiece.

THE CEILING AND ALTAR WALL

Michelangelo's ceiling of the Sistine Chapel illustrates scenes from the biblical Book of Genesis, from the creation of the world through

the fall of Adam and Eve to the story of Noah. The altar wall fresco depicts Christ's second coming and God's final judgment on humanity.



- KEY**
- Three stories of Noah
 - Prophets
 - The downfall of Adam and Eve
 - Sibyls
 - The Creation
 - Ancestors of Christ
 - Pendentives
 - Last Judgment Wall

▽ CEILING FRESCOES

Michelangelo's Sistine Chapel ceiling is brightly colored and characterized by massive, muscular figures.

The **painting** on the Sistine ceiling contains **more than 300 figures**

